

UPLOAD SLOT 07 OF 12 · USER EXPERIENCE & ACTIVATION STRATEGY

# User Experience & Activation Strategy

Who uses this park, when, and what the climate permits

Activation strategies usually assert a programme. This one derives it. The comfort model says exactly when the park is pleasant, and the programme is built to match those windows rather than to fill a calendar — which means committing, in writing, to not programming summer midday outdoors.

Al Safa 2 Park · **Falaj Al Safa** · 15,000 m² · Al Safa 2, Dubai · Mohamed Wasim, Individual Applicant · Issued 05 August 2026 · every quantity regenerated by python `run_analysis.py`

## 1. The catchment

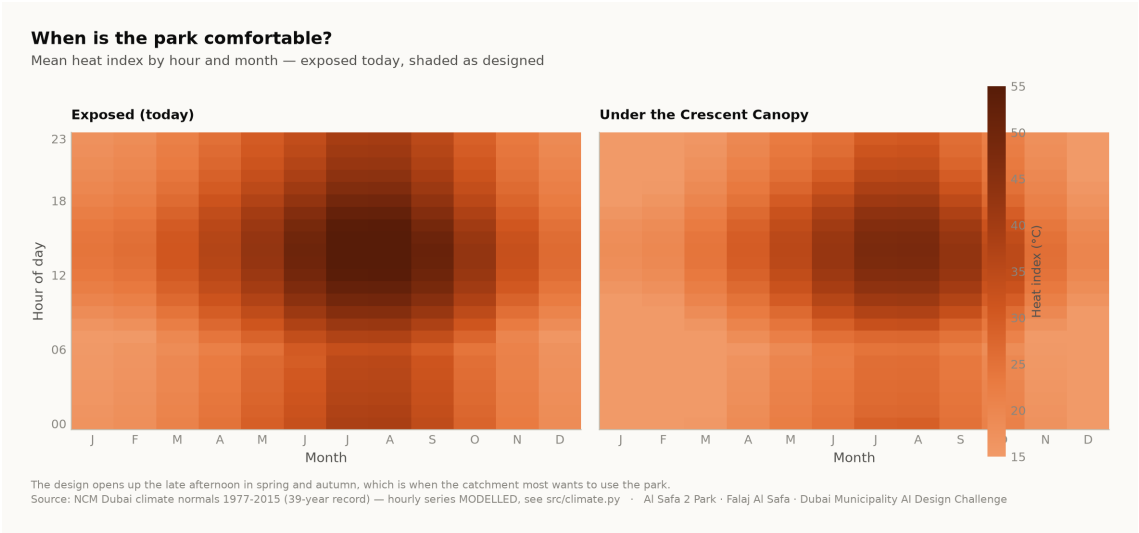
Approximately **7,640 residents** live within a ten-minute walk of the site (Dubai Statistics Center, 2023). Al Safa 2 is an established low-rise residential neighbourhood with a mixed demographic — families with young children, working adults, domestic staff, and a significant population of older residents.

## 2. Five user groups, and what each one needs

| User group                   | When they come           | What the design owes them                                                                                              |
|------------------------------|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Families with young children | Late afternoon, weekends | Play in shade, seating with sightlines to it, a drinking fountain and a restroom within sight of the play area         |
| Older residents              | Early morning, evening   | Step-free routes, shaded rest never far from the walk, seating at close intervals, no level change without a ramp      |
| Runners and walkers          | Dawn and after dark      | A continuous loop with a known distance, lit at ankle height, separated from play and picnic                           |
| Workers on a break           | Midday, year round       | The one part of the site that is genuinely cool at noon — the crescent walk and the basin                              |
| Community and events         | Evenings, cooler months  | A flexible plaza and event lawn on the convex face, with the souk adjacent so trade and programme reinforce each other |

## 3. When the park is actually comfortable

The comfort model resolves every hour of the year. Today 44.5% of daylight hours are comfortable; as designed, 64.6% are. The gain is not spread evenly, and that is the useful part: it concentrates in **late afternoon, in spring and autumn**.



Comfort by hour and by month. The design opens up the late afternoon in the shoulder seasons. Analysis output — computed from project data.

4. The activation calendar, derived from that

| Season                          | Window                              | Programme                                                                                                                                                  |
|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Oct – Apr (shoulder and winter) | 16:00 – 21:00, and weekend mornings | Community events on the plaza and event lawn, evening souk trading, outdoor fitness classes, weekend family programming                                    |
| May – Sep (summer)              | Before 09:00 and after 18:00 only   | Early running on Al Madar, evening use of the basin and the crescent walk, night programming on the plaza. <b>Nothing is scheduled outdoors at midday.</b> |

Committing to a quiet summer midday is a design position, not a gap. Programming an outdoor event into a 56 °C heat index would be a scheduling decision that the analysis in this submission directly contradicts. The park is designed so that the hours it does claim are real.

5. Comfort, accessibility and inclusion

- The site is level, so the whole park is step-free. The only change of level in the scheme is the Oasis Basin, which is ramped.
- Every room is reached from the shaded primary route by a single alley — no room requires crossing another to arrive.
- Shaded rest (the majlis pods) is never far from the walk, so a user who needs to stop can always reach shade.
- 6 drinking fountains and 2 universally accessible restroom blocks are distributed against actual dwell points, not spaced evenly for the drawing.
- Play is divided by age group, with family seating in shade and clear sightlines to both zones.

6. Day and night

The brief asks for a park that works across the whole day. The convex face carries the uses that run after dark — the plaza, the event lawn and the souk — because its exposure stops being a liability once the sun is down. The crescent is lit from within so the arc reads at night as it does by day, and Al Madar is lit at ankle height for early and late running.